

As opposed to vector images, raster images can be pulled out of a lineup when you zoom in, because on zooming in deep, even a relatively straight border in the image will show a clear row of pixels. It is for this reason that raster images are often called bitmap images, because they contain information that is directly mapped to the display grid. Raster images usually have a larger file size than vectors. This is mainly due to the large amount of information available in raster images. In addition to the metadata, the normally higher dots per inch (DPI) and pixels per inch (PPI) result in increasing the size and weight of the file, since any image editing software needs to be powerful enough to keep track of each pixel in the file and render it seamlessly.

A raster file is usually difficult to modify without loss of information, which is where good image editing suites like Photoshop and Aperture come into play. These software are capable of handling intricate image editing - making use of all the information that a raster file can hold.

The Feature Rich Software:

Lets start off by ogling at the professional tools. The real heavy duty software that the true enthusiasts use while editing their photographs.

Adobe Photoshop Pro

Platform: Windows, Mac

Price: Rs. 499- Rs. 1,000/month (Creative Cloud)

or Rs. 51,600 (CS6)

Adobe Photoshop needs little introduction. It is a photo editing software developed and published by Adobe Systems. It is, currently, the leader for commercial bitmap and image editing. Adopted professionally in every industry that can use it, Photoshop is the flagship product of Adobe Systems.

With its standardised interface, and with its interconnectivity with the Adobe Suite, several professional agencies have adopted Photoshop as the native image editing software. Paired with Adobe Lightroom - the Adobe Systems' image organisation software - Photoshop has a steep learning curve but once an editor gets the hang of its UI and tools, it opens a wide range of options to choose from.

The introduction of Adobe's Creative Cloud framework also allows for collaboration on editing work. And since everything is backed up to Adobe's Cloud service, losing changes and edits is a thing of the past (presuming,